

GLOBAL TECH SOLUTIONS

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK & POLICY MANUAL

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1. INTRODUCTION & SCOPE

This Employee Handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and benefits provided by Global Tech Solutions ("the Company"). These policies apply to all full-time employees, part-time staff, and interns working at our India locations. The Company reserves the right to modify these policies at any time.

2. EMPLOYMENT CLASSIFICATIONS

- **Full-Time Employees:** Employees scheduled to work at least 40 hours per week. Eligible for full benefits.
 - **Part-Time Employees:** Employees scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week. Eligible for pro-rated benefits.
 - **Probationers:** New hires are on probation for the first 6 months. During this period, notice period for termination is 15 days by either side.
 - **Interns:** Temporary employees hired for a fixed term (usually 3-6 months) for training purposes. Interns are not eligible for paid leave or medical insurance benefits.
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3. WORK HOURS & ATTENDANCE POLICY

3.1 Standard Work Hours

- **Office Timings:** 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday.

- **Lunch Break:** 1:00 PM to 2:00 PM (Flexible, 1 hour).
- **Total Hours:** Employees are expected to clock a minimum of 9 hours per day (including breaks).

3.2 Hybrid / Remote Work

- Employees may work from home (WFH) up to **2 days per week** with manager approval.
- "Core Hours" (11:00 AM – 4:00 PM) must be maintained regardless of location to ensure collaboration overlap.

3.3 Late Arrival Policy

- A grace period of 15 minutes is allowed (up to 9:45 AM).
 - Three (3) instances of late arrival exceeding 30 minutes in a single month will result in a deduction of 0.5 days of Casual Leave.
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4. LEAVE POLICY

The leave accounting year is January 1st to December 31st.

4.1 Casual Leave (CL)

- **Entitlement:** 12 days per annum (credited as 1 day per month).
- **Usage:** Cannot be taken for more than 3 consecutive days.
- **Carry Forward:** Unused CL lapses at the end of the year. It cannot be encashed.

4.2 Sick Leave (SL)

- **Entitlement:** 10 days per annum.
- **Usage:** Can be used for personal illness or medical appointments.
- **Requirement:** For SL exceeding 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner is mandatory.

4.3 Privilege / Earned Leave (PL/EL)

- **Entitlement:** 18 days per annum (1.5 days accrued for every month worked).
- **Eligibility:** Employees are eligible to avail PL only after completing the probation period.
- **Carry Forward:** Unused PL can be accumulated up to a maximum of 45 days. Excess PL will be encashed automatically at year-end.

4.4 Maternity & Paternity Leave

- **Maternity Leave:** Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave as per the Maternity Benefit Act.
- **Paternity Leave:** Male employees are entitled to 10 days of paid paternity leave, to be availed within 3 months of the child's birth.

5. COMPENSATION, BENEFITS & REIMBURSEMENTS

5.1 Salary Disbursement Salaries are processed on the last working day of every month. Pay slips will be available on the HRMS portal by the 2nd of the following month.

5.2 Provident Fund (PF) The Company contributes 12% of the Basic Salary towards the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF), matched by an equal contribution from the employee.

5.3 Travel & Expense Reimbursements

- **Local Travel:**
 - Personal Two-Wheeler: ₹5.00 per KM.
 - Personal Four-Wheeler: ₹12.00 per KM.
 - Cab/Taxi: At actuals (Original bill required).
- **Daily Food Allowance:**
 - Employees working in the office post 9:00 PM are eligible for a dinner allowance capped at ₹450 per instance.
- **Internet Reimbursement (Hybrid):**
 - A flat allowance of ₹1,000 per month is provided for home internet usage.

5.4 Claim Process All reimbursement claims must be submitted via the Expense Portal by the 25th of the month. Claims submitted after this date will be processed in the next payroll cycle.

6. CODE OF CONDUCT & DATA SECURITY

6.1 Data Privacy Employees must not share confidential company data, client lists, or code repositories with external parties. Use of personal USB drives on company laptops is strictly prohibited.

6.2 POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) The Company has a Zero Tolerance policy towards sexual harassment. All grievances must be reported to the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC). An investigation will be initiated within 24 hours of the complaint.

7. SEPARATION & EXIT POLICY

7.1 Notice Period

- **During Probation:** 15 Days.
- **Confirmed Employees:** 60 Days (2 Months).
- **Senior Management (VP & Above):** 90 Days.

7.2 Buyout Option Notice period buyout is at the sole discretion of the Management. If approved, the employee must pay the Basic Salary for the shortfall in notice days.

7.3 Full & Final Settlement (FnF) FnF settlement will be processed within 45 days from the employee's last working day, subject to clearance of all dues and return of company assets (Laptop, ID Card, Access Keys).